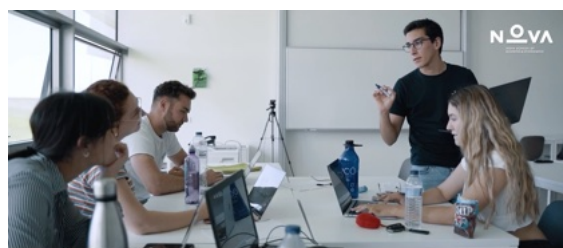


Field Lab - Work Project (WP)

Business in Practice (BiP)

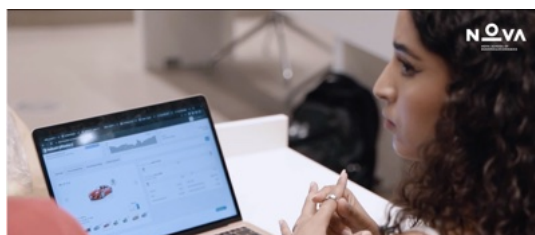
A – Background

91 students will be selected to participate in the Business in Practice WP in 2026. Students will be organised in 13 teams of 7 students to form the board of directors of a global car manufacturing company. Each student will be appointed as one of five director roles (some doubled up): *Director of Finance, Director of Marketing, Director of HR, Director of Operations and Director of Innovation* in a realistic and immersive experience of managing the transition of the business towards modern electric cars and to become a sustainable organisation.



The Business in Practice (BiP) WP is an immersive business simulation learning experience designed to enable students to apply and see the value of concepts learned about key functions of a business. Students work and compete in teams in managing a global car manufacturing company over a period of 6 years within a complex business simulation which includes real-life emergent role-plays.

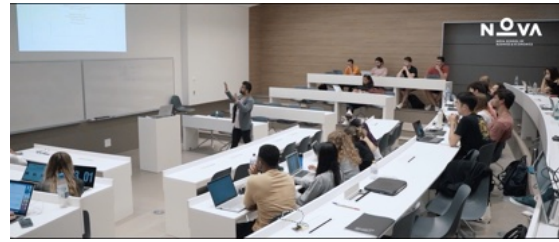
This year is the fifth edition of BIP at Nova SBE, but the programme has been successfully delivered in other Business Schools internationally and has gained teaching awards. The business simulation is unique in terms of its complexity and is used within companies like Mercedes, Coca Cola and McKinsey to train management skills in those organisations.



The teams will compete on Value Added to their business over the 6 years period but there are also prizes for best performance on each of the functions, and on their effort towards ESG and sustainability.

Please watch the following video with a review and testimonials of the first (pilot) edition of BIP in 2022:
<https://youtu.be/UXAr18IZtTE>

Central to the BiP learning experience are academic sessions led by Professors from all areas of the school: Strategy, Marketing, Finance, HR, Operations, Innovation and Sustainability. Academic sessions review key concepts and notions useful to capture insights and reflect on data from the simulation. These sessions are delivered in conjunction with industry speakers (*Practice Leads*) who are experienced senior executives to show how they manage each function in practice in their organisations. Each session is designed to empower the directors of each function to take that role in the business simulation.



Equally important are business skills workshops providing personal skills necessary for good team performance and ensure that the team is able to learn and improve how they operate and function together as the board of a global company. Each member will be assessed on their contribution by their peers and this will then be material used in the personal reflection section of the dissertation.

The teams will also need to react to unexpected situations and events, and perform in the real world through *role plays* to test their ability to cope with pressure and operate professionally as they would in a real organisation. These role plays are designed to assess their learning of core skills from the business skills workshops, including learning about sales and client engagement and presentation techniques.



The programme involves three weeks (from 15th Jun to 3rd Jul 2026) of intense engagement with live sessions on campus. Attendance to all the sessions, including weekends, is needed and mandatory for everyone participating in BiP. Tentative timetable below (dates correct but detail may change):

Business in Practice 2026 – TIMETABLE (TENTATIVE)

Location / Rooms: main auditorium for group sessions is D139, teamwork rooms: D004, D005, D007, D008, D009, D010, D011 (Provisional)

Week 1 (15 th Jun – 21 st June)						
Mon 15 June	Tue 16 June	Wed 17 June	Thu 18 Jun	Fri 19 June	Sat 20 June	Sun 21 June
10:00 Opening and Simulation overview 12:00 Sim training in teams 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Academic session on STRATEGY	10:00 Sim functional training G1: HR + Ops G2: Mkt + Innov G3: Fin 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Leading yourself Workshop	10:00 – 13:00 Academic session on FINANCE 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Academic session on MARKETING	10:00 – 13:00 Academic session on HR 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Academic session OPERATIONS BIP Social	14:00 Sim practice Teams to meet to practice/plan for Sim 14:00 Sim practice Teams to meet to practice/plan for Sim	10:00 Sim practice Teams decide when and where to meet to practice/plan for Sim 14:00 Sim practice Teams decide when and where to meet to practice/plan for Sim	
Week 2 (22 nd June – 28 th June)						
Mon 22 June	Tue 23 June	Wed 24 June	Thu 25 Jun	Fri 26 June	Sat 27 June	Sun 28 June
10:00 – 13:00 Academic session on INNOVATION 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Academic session on SUSTAINABILITY	10:00 – 13:00 Sales workshop 13h-14h lunch Assignment briefing	10:00 – 13:00 Sales Role plays 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 YEAR 1 decisions	10:00 – 13:00 YEAR 2 decisions 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Leadership in Practice Workshop BIP Social	10:00 – 13:00 YEAR 3 decisions & Sim Clinics 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Sim Clinics	Team review and prep for three final years of Sim Team review and prep for three final years of Sim	
Week 3 (29 th June – 3 rd July)						
Mon 29 June	Tue 30 June	Wed 1 Jul	Thu 2 Jul	Fri 3 Jul		
10:00 – 13:00 YEAR 4 decisions 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Client retention workshop	10:00 – 13:00 Client Role Plays & Team dynamic clinics 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 Client Role Plays & Team dynamic clinics ESG workshop (B008)	ESG ROLE PLAY 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 YEAR 5 decisions	10:00 – 12:00 Assignment briefing 13h-14h lunch 14:00 – 17:00 YEAR 6 decisions	10:00 – 12:00 Sim results debrief 12h-14h lunch and awards ceremony (Westmont TBC)		
Simulation sessions	Academic sessions	Business Skills	Breaks and social			

Updated 11/02/2026 JB

The **assessment** of BiP is based on an **individually** written thesis with two sections. The first counts 60% of the overall mark and requires students to use concepts from *three of the seven* academic sessions to analyse the performance of their companies in the business simulation. The second part counts 40% of the overall mark and is a personal reflection of the experience focused on two “critical incidents” that have been meaningful and added valuable career insights.



To do well in the two sections students need to engage deeply with the simulation and with other team members to jointly agree and deliver a long-term business strategy, and then use this experience to capture insights about themselves and the business decisions made.

Important guidelines to participate in Business in Practice 2026

We have space for 91 students and will probably need to select students based on: 1. Confirmation of *commitment* to be on campus and dedicate fully to BiP during the three weeks in June, and then able to complete the writing of the dissertation until submission in September, and 2. *interest and motivation* to work in teams in managing a business in a more applied learning experience, and 3. the *preferred role* as we need a balance across the five functions.

When applying for Business in Practice please respond to the following three points in the textbox available. More specifically please state the following:

1. Provide a statement confirming that you will be available and willing to be on campus during the three weeks of the business simulation, and that you will then be able to write your thesis during the Summer until submission in September.
2. Explain in a few words your motivation for this intensive and more applied team-oriented learning experience - What do you bring to your team, and why/how do you think BiP will enhance your future career?
3. Preferred roles: please specify which of the following roles is your preference, and also a second option. The five roles available are: Finance, Marketing, Operations, HR, Innovation.

B - Objectives of this work project

The main objective of BiP is to provide a realistic and immersive business experience of managing a large global company so that students better understand the value of the theories and concepts learned in their previous modules and gain transferable skills through the development of a coherent business strategy combining different functional perspectives in teams. Teams will compete by making business decisions but also in reacting to events and scenarios testing their preparedness to perform based on strong management structures, culture and a clear shared business strategy. It is therefore both a marathon and a sprint. The programme is designed to be intense during the three weeks of delivery in June, so the teams will be tested on their stamina and endurance and learn from this too.

The more specific learning objectives for the programme are:

1. Gain deeper understanding of each business function in organisations and apply learning in a simulated business environment.
2. Gain a better understanding of the role and purpose of each business function in organisations of: Strategy, Marketing, Operations, Finance, HR, Innovation and Sustainability.
3. Experience leading a business function in practice and manage in teams the interactions across business functions.

4. Learn personal and work transferable skills such as sales, team dynamics and reflective practice, including learn to integrate knowledge across functional areas of organisations

C- Methodology and recommended/required tools

The materials for writing the dissertation will be the concepts from the academic sessions, and then all the notes and diaries during the business simulation, as well as data available in the simulation itself. Students will be encouraged to record decisions and gather information during the three weeks to then interpret and analyse during the writing stage of the dissertation.

D- Format and End product / Deliverables:

The assessed assignment for Business in Practice follows the usual individual academic thesis format and is due in September (exact date to be confirmed). We expect the 25 pages of content in two main sections. A larger section (60% of pages) focused on *firm analysis* where students should use the data from the simulation and decisions to analyse the business performance of their companies across three of the 6 academic and functional areas (five functional roles plus strategy). And a shorter section (40% of pages) focused on a personal reflection using materials from the business skills sessions and notes taken focused on two critical incidents during the simulation.

Precise guidelines and tips for structuring the content are available in the *BIP Dissertation Handbook* which is available as a separate document, as well as specific sessions will be available during and after the three weeks of Business in Practice delivery in June.

E - Work Plan

Dates and location:

- For the business simulation students are required to be on campus every day during the three weeks of June: 15th Jun to 3rd Jul 2026
- Then to write the dissertation students are not required to be on campus. They could be anywhere where they can work on their own during the period of July, August and September. However, they must allow sufficient time to analyse the materials and develop their writing
- Submission will be around mid-September (to be confirmed), and the defences will then be in late September or October (again dates to be confirmed).

F - Readings and support materials

Readings for each academic session will be provided by the Academic Leads prior to each session. Further readings will be provided to support the business skills workshops.

G – Roles and responsibilities

Students will be working in teams to manage their company in the business simulation. They will need to create decision making structure and organise roles and responsibilities to respond to the challenges and activities in the simulation.

H – Advisors

The programme will be coordinated by Prof. João Baptista and supported by two Teaching Assistants Joana Costa and Andre Arede (both participated in the first edition of BiP and have been involved with the programme since then). Two more Professors will act as Advisers during the writing stage of the dissertation. The academic content will be delivered by the following Academic Leads:

Strategy: Prof Marco Galo

Marketing: Prof. Carmen Lages

Finance: Prof. Fernando Anjos

Operations: Prof. Ana Sofia Costa

HR: Prof Helena Martins

Innovation: Prof. Luis Lages

Sustainability: Prof. Joao Loureiro

Every academic session will be jointly delivered with an experienced speaker from the industry, typically senior executives working in these functions in the automotive industry. Previously we had Senior executives from BMW, Ford, Renault and Galp

I – Other information

Reminder to please provide the following information in the open textbox when applying for Business in Practice in the Student App:

1. Preferred role and also secondary role: please specify which of the following roles you prefer, and also mention a second option too: Finance, Marketing, Operations, HR, Innovation.
2. Provide a statement confirming that you will be available and willing to be on campus during the three weeks of the business simulation in June, and that you will then focus on writing your assignment thesis during the Summer until submission in September
3. Finally, in a few words explain your motivation for this more applied and team oriented learning experience - why do you think BiP will enhance your future career?

Advisor/Coordinator, Teaching Assistants and co-advisor short bio notes

João Baptista is the academic coordinator of Business in Practice. He is Visiting Professor at Nova SBE and Professor at Lancaster University. He created and delivered the same format of Business in Practice at Warwick Business School for 5 years. Joana Costa is NovaSBE alumni and now Digital Marketing Lead at Renault Group. Andre Arede is also NovaSBE alumni and has taken leave from McKinsey to pursue an MBA at St Gallen. Both will support the management and delivery of BiP 2026.